

Tobias Treppmann

Design leader who went hands-on into the systems and processes underneath the craft — which is how you learn what AI actually changes for designers

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA

2022 – 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland

2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organizations.

PROFILE

I lead design functions. At Ninox I ran design and, for four months, product as well: nine people across design, UX writing, product and data science. The last year has gone into the layer underneath design rather than design itself — systems, tooling, governance. Hands-on, on purpose. It is how you learn what AI is really doing to the craft, and where the opportunity in it is. At Bibel TV it means owning UI quality across iOS, Android, web and connected TV, with the standard built into the system rather than into review.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web, connected TV; no in-house design team, engineering is an external agency) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- A design system the build enforces — six checks, identical locally and in CI, over Storybook. Both compile and render.
- Design system as an API — DTCG tokens in four tiers from raw primitives through to the tokens a component consumes, built with Style Dictionary, synced live to Figma and Android.
- A color engine, and the tool that configures it — k-means clustering in OKLCH rather than RGB, so themes carry perceptual weight.
- AI-enablement in frontend, in production for a year — I prototype against real APIs, web first then Android, and engineering ships from that code. That engineering is an external agency, so the handoff crosses a company boundary.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Two functions at once, nine reports, four disciplines — from July to October 2023 I ran Product Design and Product together as one domain. Senior Leadership Team throughout.
- Design made co-equal, by agreement rather than assertion — a collaborative self-assessment with product and engineering, after which design held parity in planning instead of receiving finished decisions.
- Hired 2, promoted 2, and made the other call twice — including hiring the consultant who then took Head of Product permanently.
- Prompt-to-database onboarding, with the CEO and technical co-founder (freelance, summer 2025) — the AI-generated schema renders into the real data-model editor, not a chat preview.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — ~50 people, DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Accessibility shipped under regulation, not advocated — AI alt-text generation for EU accessibility compliance, under GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law, across six countries.
- Booking module — the decision I defended through the build — inherited a €20k client-funded project scoped as a standalone add-on and reframed it into a platform capability, holding that line to delivery.
- Product management and all of product design at once — priority setting and resource allocation were mine: I wrote the specs, ran the ticket board engineering worked from.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Five years of data-dense enterprise interfaces — pivot tables, column charts, aggregated JSON views, result cards and filter logic.
- Design system — I defined component behavior and specs across the library, and the UI designers executed the visual system.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) · Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Service-to-product transformation — partnered with the executive team to productize the service organization. Case-by-case support became a standard catalog. Ran design-thinking training for that leadership team and for the service teams.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany · 200+ people

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA

Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2008 – 2009 · Düsseldorf, Germany

Freelance Web Designer · 2003 – 2008 · Düsseldorf, Germany

Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2000 – 2003 · Düsseldorf, Germany

SKILLS

Design Infrastructure and Frontend Technologies

Design system as an API at Bibel TV: DTCG tokens in four tiers from raw primitives through to the tokens a component consumes, Style Dictionary, live sync to Figma and Android · One commit propagates to every platform · Storybook as the source of truth with a prototyping layer on top · Six checks, identical locally and in CI, that refuse off-system work · The system reports its own token gaps: eight so far, in the order people hit them

AI-Enablement in Frontend and Design

Agentic engineering in production for a year · Prototypes built in real code against real production APIs, web first then Android · engineering ships from that code · The handoff crosses a company boundary to an external engineering agency and holds anyway · The token vocabulary handed to the assistant as an enumerated list rather than recalled, so it cannot invent · Claude Code, Claude skills, Cursor and Zed as daily tools

Craft Leadership and Visual Strategy

Built Bibel TV's color engine and the tool that configures it, both live in production · K-means clustering in OKLCH rather than RGB, so themes carry even perceptual weight across a grid · Text validated against base with the WCAG algorithm and adjusted until the pair passes, so no theme ships failing · Selah — Mindful Transitions: a macOS app designed, built and shipped solo on the Mac App Store

Leading More Than One Team

Product Design and Product held together at Ninox from July to October 2023 · Nine reports across four disciplines — product design, UX writing, product management and data science · Senior Leadership Team · Hired two, promoted two, and made the other call twice · Design team across Germany and NYC for five years at Datameer · Design-system governance run as a cross-functional working group with an escalation path

Accessibility and Regulated Delivery

AI alt-text generation shipped for EU accessibility compliance at ChurchDesk · Under GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law, across six countries · WCAG contrast validated inside the color engine rather than checked afterwards · Datameer operated under HIPAA compliance among other frameworks

Organizational Change

Design established as co-equal with product and engineering at Ninox through a collaborative self-assessment rather than an imposed model · Instrumental in the UX maturity shift across a 200-plus person matrix organization at Spreadshirt, where nothing could be mandated · Service-to-product transformation with the executive team at Hypoport · Collaboration norms redesigned around how people actually work, which outlived the case that prompted them